

5 Signs Your Business Has Outgrown Off-the-Shelf Software

A practical guide for UK business owners

SIGN 1

Your team has built workarounds that everyone accepts as normal.

Exporting to a spreadsheet because the system cannot do the calculation.

Entering the same data twice because systems do not connect.

→ **Workarounds are a signal, not a solution.**

SIGN 2

You pay for features you never use
while missing ones you need daily.

Off-the-shelf tools are built for
every business in your sector.
Not specifically for yours.

→ **You are paying for someone else's requirements.**

SIGN 3

Onboarding requires training
on the workarounds — not the software.

When the gap between how the tool
works and how you use it needs
explicit training, the tool is wrong.

→ **The software should fit the business.**

SIGN 4

Data lives in multiple places
and nobody is sure which is current.

Spreadsheets filling the gaps.

Emails as the authoritative record.

One person who knows where things are.

→ **Scattered data is a systems problem.**

SIGN 5

The monthly cost is significant
but the value feels unclear.

SaaS pricing rises every year.
You are paying more for the same tool
while your needs have grown beyond it.

→ **Do the 3-year cost calculation.**

Sound familiar?

A custom tool built around your exact process typically pays for itself within 12-18 months.

Book a free 30-minute call.
We will tell you if it makes sense for your specific situation.

[Book a free call](#)

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